

Derek Staley

Wichita Falls, TX | (415) 509-8471 | dstaley@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/dcstaley/](https://www.linkedin.com/in/dcstaley/)

Summary

Production and project leader with 13+ years of experience across tech, games, and entertainment, transitioning into product management. Proven track record launching new products and verticals, building Agile delivery processes from scratch, and keeping cross-functional teams aligned and moving through complex execution. Personal project experience building an AI-powered analytics application, owning all product requirements and feature development from the ground up. Strong background in roadmap execution, stakeholder alignment, and iterative delivery. Certified Scrum Master.

Professional Experience

Producer, Demiurge Studios

2023 – 2025

- Led feature prioritization and roadmap planning for Riot Games on both Teamfight Tactics and 2XKO, navigating product vision, design intent, and technical feasibility across disciplines
- Drove alignment between Riot's game teams and Demiurge's engineering and art disciplines on requirements, deliverables, and priorities across both engagements
- Partnered with Riot product and design leadership to turn product vision into clear, well-scoped development plans with defined acceptance criteria
- Managed resource planning and dependency tracking, adapting plans as scope and team needs evolved
- Generated reports from JIRA tracking data to communicate feature status, surface risks, and inform prioritization decisions with studio and client leadership

Program Manager, MGM Resorts International

2021 – 2023

- Built production and delivery processes for a newly formed product and development team, including agile workflow, backlog management, sprint cadence, and tooling
- Partnered with finance and business stakeholders on budget planning, staffing, and resource decisions across multiple concurrent roadmaps
- Collaborated with Lead Product Manager on roadmap planning to establish realistic timelines and prioritization

Senior Project Manager, The Zebra

2019 – 2021

- Joined as an early PM hire and established company-wide best practices, policies, and tooling from the ground up
- Led the launch of the home insurance vertical, the first major extension of the core business, from initial scoping through go-to-market execution
- Established executive-level reporting dashboards providing visibility into delivery health, blockers, and progress as the organization scaled
- Mentored engineering leads and managers on Agile processes, estimation, and backlog prioritization

Agile Project Manager, Confluence Inc

2017 – 2019

- Led dev support team, designing and implementing processes for prioritizing client requests alongside planned development work
- Established company-wide processes to predict and communicate the timing of bug fixes, patches, and new features, improving client satisfaction and stakeholder transparency
- Led the transition of a 20-year-old engineering team onto modern agile processes, including backlog management, sprint planning, and retrospectives

Project Manager, Ellation (Crunchyroll)

2016 – 2017

- Led the launch of VRV, a new video streaming platform, simultaneously shipping on iOS, Android, Xbox One, and PS4 and hitting all target launch dates through tight scope and resourcing decisions
- Created dashboards surfacing critical path items and blockers for both engineering teams and executive leadership
- Partnered with technical leadership to implement live deployment processes across all backend services

Project Manager, Big Fish Games

2015 – 2016

- Managed planning and execution for live updates on a top-10 grossing iOS and Android game
- Coordinated across development, Product, QA, and Marketing to ensure requirements were fully defined before developer handoff

- Implemented Scrum and Kanban processes tailored to each team's workflow and delivery needs

Project Manager, Branding Brand

2013 – 2014

- Managed relationships with multiple remote international client teams, covering existing properties, new projects, and future engagements
- Led the kickoff, development, and launch of the company's first international travel site

Associate Product Manager, Kixeye

2011 – 2013

- Partnered with game design and UX teams on creation, testing, and development of new features
- Owned final quality of features from development completion through launch and performance metrics

Projects

OOTP Perfect Team Roster Optimizer | Personal Project, 2025 – Present

A web application for optimizing tournament rosters in OOTP Baseball's Perfect Team mode. Built entirely using Claude AI, with all product requirements, data models, scoring logic, and feature specifications written and owned by me.

- Designed a dual-mode scoring engine backed by regression models (wOBA event-rate and linear weighted) trained on real game data, with adjustments for era, park factors, and platoon splits
- Built a user-facing model training interface that allows retraining of scoring models against any league's exported statistics
- Specified a linear programming optimization layer (HiGHS solver) that selects optimal 26-card rosters subject to position eligibility, budget caps, tier slot limits, two-way player rules, and lineup balance constraints
- Ongoing project with active feature development, generating competitive results in live tournament play

Claude Cowork Productivity App | In Progress, 2026 – Present

Developing a productivity application with all product requirements, documentation, and project planning owned and managed using Claude Cowork.

Skills

Product & Delivery: Product Roadmapping, Feature Prioritization, Backlog Management, Go-to-Market Planning, Agile, Scrum, Kanban, JIRA, Confluence

Leadership & Collaboration: Cross-functional Leadership, Stakeholder Management, Executive Communication, Team Mentorship

AI & Data: Generative AI, Prompt Engineering, AI-Directed Product Development

Certifications: Certified Scrum Master (CSM)

Education

B.S., Information Science and Technology — Penn State University